



at the end of the season.

Replacing Carles Cuadrat, Bruzon led the side to the IFA Shield final and the Super Cup final, providing rare stability in uncertain times. But that stability also became a point of conflict with the Red-and-Gold Brigade.

"There is no long-term vision, there is no planning, there are no talks of keeping the key players in the team. There is nothing at all about the future of East Bengal," he said, adding that May 31 will be his last day at the club, with the final fixture against Inter Kashi.

While he shuts the door behind him, another manager has opened one in God's Own Country. Ashley Westwood, who won the I-League with Bengaluru FC, took over Kerala Blasters FC mid-season when it was struggling in the bottom three.

Though he lost his first match against Sporting Club Delhi, the Blasters won three of the next four games, drawing the other, as relegation fears eased.

Meanwhile, Jamshedpur FC beat Super Cup champion FC Goa to provisionally lead the standings after 11 matches. Defending champion Mohun Bagan Super Giant beat NorthEast United FC in a rain-marred encounter,



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Clutch finish: NorthEast United's Parthib Gogoi (red) scored a 90th-minute winner against Inter Kashi. AIFF MEDIA

once again raising questions about playing conditions in India.

The Highlanders, though, bounced back in their next match, riding on clinical finishes from Indian forwards Jithin MS and Parthib Gogoi to beat Inter Kashi 3-2 in the final minute of regulation time.

Lower down the table, Mohammedan Sporting Club showed some fight, drawing three consecutive matches after 10 straight losses. But the late resurgence may prove too little, too late as relegation looms like a familiar shadow.

And then there is Diamond Harbour (**left**). Its coach, Kibu Vicuña, who won the I-League title with Bagan in 2020, has inspired DHFC to consecutive promotions, and now, a win against Rajasthan United could secure the club's place in the top flight.

(All results updated until May 4)